

Danyal Rao

San Francisco Bay Area, CA | US Citizen | dtrao100@gmail.com | 714-987-8291

[https://danyal-rao.vercel.app | linkedin.com/in/danyal-rao]

SUMMARY

Product designer with 3 years end-to-end design for regtech B2B AI <compliance/insurance/legal>. Sole design lead on Complify (Conviction-backed compliance AI for audit workflows) translating regulator-shaped complexity into interfaces underwriters, auditors, and customers actually want to use. Trusted by multiple YC founders. Founded Aether Studios in 2025 to scale this model for early-stage founders. AI-native workflow (Claude Code, Cursor, Figma) ships at the scope of a small product team.

EXPERIENCE

Founder & Lead Designer

Apr 2025 – Present

Aether Studios: AI-Native Design Studio

San Francisco Bay Area, CA

- First design hire for YC- and tier-1-VC-backed startups in regulated AI verticals (compliance, audit, insurance). Built a portfolio at **\$200K+ ARR run rate**, fully async-remote.
- Ship high-fidelity UI and interactive prototypes via AI-native workflow (Claude Code, Cursor, Tailwind). Every engagement leaves a reusable design system, decision logs, and handoff specs to improve internal company systems thinking as opposed to one-off artifact deliverables.

Product Designer (Contract)

Nov 2025 – Present

Complify: Conviction VC backed Compliance Agents

San Francisco Bay Area, CA

- Sole product designer working directly with CEO Morris Hsu and the founding engineering team. AI platform automating audit workflows (User Access Reviews) for regulated firms. **Landed RSM (top 5 audit firm) on a paid pilot** off the prototype work, while leading live demoing in the first sales call.
- Translated regulator-shaped complexity into a wizard that auditors actually want to use. Pivoted setup from a node-based configurator to sequential steps; **reduced audit spec creation from days to under 30 minutes**. Tested with live audit data from Zillow Home Loans (365 employees, 53 flagged samples) and SeatGeek.
- Built the design system from scratch in Figma and code: data tables, confidence indicators, test result cards, field-extraction states, source-traceable document viewers. Shipped 18+ hosted prototypes in 3 months, iterated with user testing.

Product Designer

Jan 2025 – Mar 2025

SafetyWing: YC-backed insurance for nomads

Remote

- Designed SafetyWing's nomad health insurance checkout to improve clarity and conversion between their two main packages. **Translated underwriting constraints into a plain-language UX that lifted checkout conversion 20%**. 25+ user interviews shaped pricing, onboarding, and checkout decisions.

Product Designer (Contract)

Jun 2024 – Sep 2024

ServiceNow: Fortune 500 Enterprise SaaS

San Diego, CA

- Solo-led design for the Agent Workspace notepad, simplifying a complex enterprise workflow where sensitive data was leaking into Notepad.exe. Shipped to **8,000+ monthly agents** across Starbucks, Spectrum, Disney, Jack in the Box, and Zillow. **100% adoption** among the target audience.
- Extended ServiceNow's design system for new use cases across the business unit. 15+ user research sessions with frontline agents over 3 months.

EDUCATION

University of California, San Diego

La Jolla, CA

B.S. Human-Computer Interaction and Design, Minor in Computer Science

Research assistant at UCSD Design Lab. Also junior designer under **Don Norman**, author of *The Design of Everyday Things*, known as founder of the field of Human-Centered Design and HCI.